

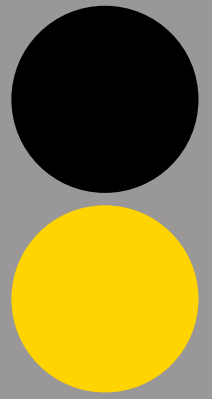


EXPAND YOUR WORLD

GERMAN

LEVEL 1

LESSON 3



Vocab

to say / tell	sagen
not	nicht
excuse me / I'm sorry (informal)	entschuldigung
I'm sorry.	Das tut mir leid.
thank you	danke (schön)
please / you're welcome	bitte (schön)
to study (at university)	studieren

Grammar

Welcome to your next lesson of German! In the last lesson, we learned about the noun genders & the first two noun cases. In this lesson, we are going to learn a bit more about the accusative case. In the first lesson, you learned about the nominative (subject) pronouns. Now we are going to learn the accusative forms of the pronouns.

Accusative Pronouns

Whenever a pronoun is used as the direct object of a verb, you must use the accusative form. You originally learned the nominative pronouns: *ich, du, er, sie, es, wir, ihr, & sie*. Now let's learn the accusative forms of these pronouns, also known as the **accusative pronouns**. In English, these are referred to as "object pronouns".

Let's look at a chart of the German nominative pronouns you previously learned with their accusative equivalents. We will include the English subject & object pronouns for translation purposes.

PRONOUNS

Nominative	Accusative
ich <i>I</i>	mich <i>me</i>
du <i>you (sing./inf.)</i>	dich <i>you (sing./inf.)</i>
er <i>he</i>	ihn <i>him</i>
sie <i>she</i>	sie <i>her</i>
es <i>it</i>	es <i>it</i>
wir <i>we</i>	uns <i>us</i>
ihr <i>you (plural/inf.)</i>	euch <i>you (plural/inf.)</i>
sie <i>they</i>	sie <i>them</i>

Let's see some examples of these accusative pronouns in use! We will use the same color coding as previously used: **green** for **nominative** nouns and pronouns & **blue** for **accusative** nouns and pronouns.

Ich verstehe **dich**.

I understand you.

Er sieht mich nicht.

He doesn't see me.

Ich habe es!

I have it!

Du kennst ihn.

You know him.

Die Frau hört uns.

The woman hears us.

Verstehst du mich?

Do you understand me?

Expressing “it”

Up until now, we taught that “es” means “it”. This is true, but it’s a bit more in depth in German. Since German nouns all have their own gender, the way we refer to nouns using pronouns must match this gender.

This means, if a noun is masculine, and you want to say “it” to refer to the masculine noun, you must call it “he” or “him” (*er/ihn*). If the noun is feminine, you’ll technically call it “she” or “her” (*sie*). If the noun is neuter or unknown, you’ll call it the generic “it”(*es*).

Ich höre das Auto. Hörst du es?

I hear the car. Do you hear it?

Since “Auto” is neuter, you refer to it with the neuter “es”.

Ich höre die Maschine. Hörst du sie?

I hear the machine. Do you hear it?

Since “Maschine” is feminine, you refer to it with the feminine “sie”.

Ich höre den Klang. Hörst du ihn?

I hear the sound. Do you hear it?

Since “Klang” is masculine, you refer to it with the masculine “er/ihn”.

The Word “man”

The last thing we will cover in this lesson is the German word “man”. Sometimes in English we use the word “you” to refer to people in general and not just the person we are talking to. For example, we might say, “you have to pay with cash here.” We don’t mean *just* the person we are talking to, rather we are meaning anyone who pays here has to use cash.

In more formal English, we could say, “one must pay with cash here.” This expresses the general meaning more clearly, but it sounds a bit outdated or formal. In German, however, this practice is still customary in everyday speech.

The word to use in German is “man”. We treat this word like a pronoun to mean “one” or the general “you”. It is a third person singular pronoun, so it makes verbs conjugate just like *er*, *sie*, & *es* do, adding the present tense ending “-t”.

Unlike genders, nouns don't "belong" to a case. Instead, nouns can be used in each case depending on its role in the sentence. Why are noun cases important? Well, nouns, articles, and other words can actually change form when put into different cases!

Wie sagt **man** **das** auf Deutsch?

How does one say that in German?

How do you say that in German?

Man sagt ...

One says ...

You say ...

Man muss hier stoppen.

One must stop here.

You have to stop here.

*Note: the verb "muss" doesn't have the "-t" ending because it's irregular and follows different rules.
You'll learn about this later.*

That's the end of the grammar portion of this lesson, but this lesson isn't over yet! Now that you've learned a chunk of German grammar and vocab, you're ready for your first ever German reading section. Each lesson will now include this section after the grammar section.

Reading

Here is your very first German reading passage! This reading starts out with very simple German for you. Each lesson from now on will have this section so you can start to practice what you've learned, learn new vocabulary words not included in your lists, & increase your general fluency. You will notice the sections will include grammar concepts you haven't learned quite yet. This helps to get your wheels turning & will test your ability to understand things by context before learning the details.

The idea for this section is to first read the entire passage in German. Try to understand the general meaning of the passage before looking up any words. You may not understand most of it at first, and that's expected! Then, reread the passage, writing down any word you don't know. Next, look up each word you wrote down, preferably in a trusted German dictionary (dict.leo.org is a great online dictionary). Read the English translation provided and see if all the vocab you looked up matches the translation. Lastly, reread the German passage and glance at your new words as needed. Treat this section as active practice, not passive reading!

Hallo! Ich heie Jans. Ich bin ein Junge. Ich spreche Englisch, Deutsch, Spanisch, und Portugiesisch. Ich lerne Arabisch und Russisch. Ich wohne in den USA. Ich liebe Kirche, und ich mag Schule. Ich unterrichte gern. Ich studiere Sprachen gern. Ich habe Fragen fr dich. Wie heit du? Was sprichst du? Was lernst du? Wo wohnst du? Was liebst du, und was magst du? Hast du Fragen fr mich? Na, ich muss gehen. Tschss!

Hello! I am called Jans (My name is Jans). I am a boy. I speak English, German, Spanish, and Portuguese. I am learning Arabic and Russian. I live/reside in the USA. I love church, and I like school. I teach gladly (I like to teach). I study languages gladly (I like to study languages). I have questions for you. How are you called (what's your name)? What do you speak? What are you learning? Where do you live/reside? What do you love, and what do you like? Do you have questions for me? Well, I must go. Bye!